MAISON • TYPOGRAPHY ROUND

Tighten Tailored House, then test three cleaner sans-serif routes beside it

This pass does exactly what you asked: one tighter Tailored House baseline, plus three other sans-serif directions built seriously instead of thrown in as filler. The point is not novelty, it is to see what actually holds Maison together best.

The question is no longer whether Tailored House was the strongest signal. It was.

Now the useful test is whether a tighter Tailored House still wins once it is put beside three modern sans-serif options with equally controlled spacing.

WHAT I'M TESTING

Warmth, control, and whether the wordmark feels like a home brand instead of a generic app or fashion label.

WHAT I TIGHTENED

Tracking, internal rhythm, and how the mark sits in real landing and product copy, not just on a blank stage.

DIRECTION 01

Tailored House, tighter

LEADER

This is the stronger version of the one you already liked. It is more compact, more deliberate, and less airy. It feels more like a real decision now.

MAISON

Still the nicest emotional fit. The tightened spacing gives it more confidence without losing the warmth that made Tailored House the best of the earlier round.

Reading: warm, tailored, expensive without showing off

Tracking: tight

MAISON

This is still the one that feels most naturally at home with Antique Walnut.

Dark test: strong

BRAND LOCKUP

FOUNDING LAUNCH

MAISON

A home feels better when it is held together beautifully.

PRODUCT CONTEXT

A calmer way to run a home.

The wordmark carries warmth without turning soft or lifestyle-generic.

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See the flow

STRENGTH

Best balance of domestic warmth, structure, and long-term identity.

RISK	If pushed much tighter it could stiffen. The warmth is in the proportions, not in extra styling tricks.
READ	Still my favorite, and better now than the first Tailored House pass.

DIRECTION 02

Instrument Sans, close control

This is the cleanest modern sans-serif option in the group. It feels sharp, composed, and current, but less domestic than Tailored House.

MAISON

Very clean. It reads like a serious product brand immediately. The tradeoff is that it loses some of the house warmth unless the color and photography do a lot of work.

Reading: controlled, modern, product-forward

Tracking: tight-minus

MAISON

Looks expensive and clean on dark, but a touch more app-brand than home-brand.

Dark test: very good

BRAND LOCKUP

FOUNDING LAUNCH

MAISON

A sharper, more product-native expression of Maison.

PRODUCT CONTEXT

A steadier household, minus the friction.

Good if you want Maison to feel cleaner and more contemporary.

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How it works

STRENGTH

Most precise and product-ready of the sans-serif options.

RISK	Easier to drift into generic startup polish if the rest of the brand system gets too clean.
READ	Strong contender if you decide warmth should come more from color than from type.

DIRECTION 03

Manrope, heavy and quiet

This one is softer and heavier at the same time. It has some presence, but it reads more digital than editorial.

MAISON

There is something good in the weight here. It feels dependable. But it leans more software-brand than maison-brand unless handled very carefully.

Reading: sturdy, quiet, digital

Tracking: tight

MAISON

The dark read is nice, but this still feels more platform than home object.

Dark test: solid

BRAND LOCKUP

FOUNDING LAUNCH

MAISON

Useful if Maison wants more sturdiness than softness.

PRODUCT CONTEXT

Home upkeep, held together clearly.

Credible and clean, but not the most distinctive or emotional.

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See the dashboard

STRENGTH

Feels dependable and easy to use in product surfaces.

RISK	May be too digital and too generic once it leaves the mockup deck and becomes a real brand mark.
READ	Not bad, but not beating Tailored House for Maison specifically.

DIRECTION 04

Plus Jakarta Sans, warmer modern

This is the warmest of the three sans-serif directions. It keeps a contemporary feel, but the curves make it friendlier and a little more domestic.

MAISON

The best sans-serif challenger in this set. It feels less cold than Instrument Sans and less digital-heavy than Manrope.

Reading: modern, approachable, warmer than the others

Tracking: tight

MAISON

This one keeps enough softness to survive the darker Antique Walnut mood.

Dark test: strong

BRAND LOCKUP

FOUNDING LAUNCH

MAISON

A cleaner route that still has a little human warmth.

PRODUCT CONTEXT

A better rhythm for everything your home needs.

If you want a sans route, this is the one that gets closest.

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View the flow

STRENGTH	Best blend of modern clarity and approachable warmth among the sans-serif options.
RISK	Still less ownable and less atmospheric than the tightened Tailored House route.
READ	The only sans-serif alternative here that feels like a real threat to Tailored House.

RECOMMENDATION

What I would carry forward

BEST OVERALL

Tailored House, tighter still wins. It has the most Maison character and now the spacing is finally doing it justice.

BEST SANS-SERIF CHALLENGER

Plus Jakarta Sans is the strongest modern alternative if you want to test a cleaner route without going cold.

WHAT THIS CLARIFIED

Maison can wear a sans-serif, but the more purely modern the type gets, the more the brand starts losing its home-specific emotional read.

RECOMMENDATION

I would keep pushing **Tailored House, tighter** as the lead, with **Plus Jakarta Sans** as the only sans-serif direction worth carrying into another serious pass.